

On target: Kylian Mbappe scored a blistering hattrick against FC Kairat. AFP

out of a possible nine as its title defence turned into a sterner test. Olympique de Marseille, led by manager Roberto De Zerbi, was gifted a win by the Parisians after captain Marquinhos fumbled the ball into his own net five minutes into their clash.

While it managed a 2-0 win against Auxerre, in its following game, PSG was troubled by Kylian Mbappe's brother, Ethan, who helped LOSC Lille hold the French giant to a 1-1 draw. After Nuno Mendes gave the visitor the lead, Ethan, a former PSG player himself, came off the bench with eight minutes remaining and fired the ball into the bottom left corner, with his brother watching from the stands. Marseille, meanwhile, kept its winning run alive, beating RC Strasbourg and FC Metz, climbing to second in the standings with 15 points, one behind leader PSG.

Additionally, Ansu Fati seems to be settling in nicely with AS Monaco, scoring in three straight league games, including a brace in his side's 2-2 draw against OGC Nice. He leads the league's goalscoring charts with five, level with Strasbourg's Joaquin Panichelli.

UEFA Champions League

We are only two matchdays into the latest edition of the top tier of European football, and the surprise results and upsets are already in full flow. Perhaps the biggest of them all was Liverpool's. The Reds, coming off a successful season and an equally good transfer window, succumbed to a 1-0 defeat against Turkish champion Galatasaray. Dominik Szoboszlai gave away an early penalty, which was coolly converted by masked marksman Victor Osimhen, condemning Arne Slot's side to a forgettable night in Istanbul.

But the blockbuster clash of the matchday was between heavy-hitters Paris Saint-Germain and FC Barcelona. Despite fielding a depleted side against the Spanish giant, the Parisians proved why they are the



defending champions, eking out a 2-1 victory and marking a third successive away triumph against the Catalans.

The visitor was put on the back foot after Marcus Rashford found Ferran Torres in front of goal after beating PSG's offside trap. However, PSG levelled things up before half-time thanks to a blistering run from Nuno Mendes, who set up a goal for 19-year-old Senny Mayulu. The game transformed into a gripping affair after that, with both sides wasting chances to take the lead. However, it was PSG substitute Goncalo Ramos who had the final say, firing in from close range in the 90th minute.

Meanwhile, Barca's arch-rival Real Madrid had contrasting fortunes on its trip to Almaty — the easternmost city ever to host a game in the competition. Kylian Mbappe kept up his fiery start to the season with a hat-trick, while Eduardo Camavinga and Brahim Diaz piled on the misery on debutant and Kazakhstani champion FC Kairat.

Atletico Madrid also made light work of Eintracht Frankfurt, winning 5-1 in a game that saw Antoine Griezmann net his 200th goal for the club. German giants Bayern Munich and Borussia Dortmund notched up big wins against Pafos and Athletic Bilbao to maintain their unbeaten start to the campaign.

English clubs Manchester City and Tottenham Hotspur dropped precious points after being held to 2-2 draws by AS Monaco and Bodo/Glimt, respectively, while Chelsea managed to edge Benfica 1-0 at home in a game which marked former manager Jose Mourinho's return to Stamford Bridge. Its London rival Arsenal banked on Gabriel Martinelli and Bukayo Saka's strikes to take all three points against Olympiacos.

Only six clubs — among them Bayern, Real, PSG, Inter Milan and Arsenal — have had a perfect start to the new season in Europe, with Azerbaijani club Qarabağ FK the unexpected entrant in the list.

Results updated as of October 6